

to get a good set of speakers and a headphone so that you can listen to stuff without broadcasting the sound to everyone in the room.

Speakers - The common models available follow a simple convention. The 2.1 set indicates that there are 2 normal speakers (called satellite speakers) and 1 bass speaker (they're also called woofers). A 5.1 system comes with 5 satellites and 1 woofer, so you can see how the notation is used. Motherboards don't have audio amplifiers that can output much power so the advantage in getting these speaker systems is that they have their own audio amplifier built into the woofer unit. These speaker sets often have an audio jack for headphones so that the moment you plug them in the external speakers get muted and only the headphones give any output. The bass and treble can be easily adjusted via knobs present on the woofer unit or a separate remote control. The remote may be wired or wireless so choose whatever you fancy.

Headphones - A headphone is a combination of two miniature earphones, one for each ear. A headset is a combination of a headphone and a microphone. The microphone is usually mounted on an adjustable shaft, so the orientation and length can be easily adjusted to one's liking. Nowadays headsets do come with multiple speakers built into each earpiece, so you don't have to be concerned about poor bass reproduction when using the headset. Headsets are generally huge and sit over your ears but there are ones that sit right on your ears perfectly, each arrangement has its own advantage.



Types

Circumaural - These headphones are pretty huge and come to rest on your head while completely encompassing your ears. The design by itself isolates a lot of outside noise but complete noise isolation has a lot more to do with the circuitry rather than just the construction.

Supraaural - These headphones are the same size as your ear and come to rest on your outer ear.

Earbuds - These sit just outside the ear canal and do not have a headband to hold the two earpieces together.